

THE NORTH STAR

1,000 keg systems in the market. Every decision gets tested against whether it moves that number.

The shape decision underneath it: refills lead, and the Tap Room stops being run as a walk-in venue. It becomes a destination that sells events, tours and functions. The two halves have been cancelling each other out, because a good refill business takes traffic out of the room.

If nothing is decided, the default continues. Marketing time keeps going to the half that loses money, the best insights stay buried in a long document, and 1,000 systems stays a number on a slide.

Why this exists. Christy's reading of the Discovery set was that everything in it is equal, so none of it has shape: everything is important, the best insights are buried inside other insights, and nothing has been stress-tested. Clent asked for three things off the back of it, and they are the test for this page. Belief, because the work is already good. Clarity, on which few things get picked up. Momentum, because a decision made is worth more than a strategy admired.

North star proposed by Christy in the 15 September catch-up. Numbers on this sheet come from the Discovery pack unless marked.

WHERE WE START FROM

96–113
ACTIVE REFILL CUSTOMERS, NO PUSH

206
SYSTEMS IN THE DATABASE

56%
BOUGHT THEIR SYSTEM ELSEWHERE

~9x
THE CLIMB TO 1,000 FROM HERE

40%
LAPSED, REASON SPLIT UNSETTLED

1:10
WHOLESALE ACCOUNT VS HOUSEHOLD

FOUR PLANS, ONE MOVE EACH : the rest of this pack is a page per plan

BUSINESS

Stop funding the losing half.

Pause walk-in trading and redirect that spend into refills and wholesale. Resource wholesale properly, because one account is worth about ten households and it is currently falling through the cracks.

First step: Justin confirms the walk-in call, and wholesale gets a person with a target.

BRAND

Own the category, not the price.

The enemy is the overpriced pub, not the operator across the road. Cut the tail of about 19 brews to a set of heroes, put the Crafted award everywhere, and start designing for her.

First step: the award goes on the site, the room and the decals this month.

SALES AND MARKETING

Connect the system before spending more.

Website, POS and CRM do not talk to each other, so every campaign underperforms. Then convert the owners who already bought elsewhere and take the friction out of reordering.

First step: connect the three systems, then replace the 90-day SMS.

ACTIVATION

Sell the room as a destination.

Tours, weddings, functions and ticketed events, with the artwork and the booking path already built. Partnerships where the systems are already being sold.

First step: get on the tour circuit and open the Harvey Norman conversation.

SEQUENCE

NOW

Justin picks the moves he is committing to. Connect the data. Pause walk-in spend.

NEXT

Convert existing owners. Fix reorder friction. Stand wholesale up as a role with targets.

LATER

Range rationalisation, the wellness line, designing for her, and the duopoly workaround.

Nothing in Later starts until the Now column is done. That is the discipline the plan is buying.

WHO OWNS WHAT

WORKSTREAM	OWNS IT	SUPPORTS
The shape decision	Justin	Clent, Christy
Connected data and CRM	Jewell Projects	Tap That
Wholesale	New hire or agent	Justin
Destination programme	Tap That	Jewell Projects
Partnerships	Clent	Justin
Brand and range	Justin	Christy

A full responsibility matrix sits on the Activation sheet. This is the summary of it.

WHAT JUSTIN DECIDES FIRST

■ Do we pause walk-in trading?

Everything on the Business sheet follows from this one.

■ Do we resource wholesale?

A person with targets, not a founder in spare hours.

■ Canning: in or out?

It buys awareness and it competes with the refill model.

■ Does membership attach to every system sale?

Non-members leak at 44%, members at 18%.

■ How far do we cut the range?

Heroes need the marketing that the tail is absorbing.

Agreed in the catch-up: the team reviews the deck and comes back with the commitments before the next conversation.



WHERE THE MONEY ACTUALLY IS

The system is the barrier. The refill is the business. Attention has been going to neither.

Systems go out close to cost, and the margin arrives later at roughly **\$70 gross a keg**. That makes this a subscription business wearing a brewery’s clothes. A subscription business needs people to stay home and reorder. The Tap Room needs them to come in. Eighteen months of attention went to the half that loses money.

The fix is not optimisation, it is reshaping. Running a brewery and a hospitality venue on a skeleton staff is not a resourcing problem to be solved with more hours.

Reshaping means three concrete things: the room stops being staffed for walk-in trade it does not get, the spend that was chasing footfall moves to refills and wholesale, and somebody owns wholesale as a job rather than as an evening.

Per-keg margin and system economics from the Discovery pack. Test them against the current P&L before the plan is signed.

THE FOUR UNITS, AND THE CALL ON EACH

UNIT	TODAY	THE CALL
Refills	96–113 active, at MVP, reached with no push	Scale. This is the business
Tap Room	Walk-in trade does not cover it. Events already do	Pivot. Destination, not walk-in
Wholesale	Approaches come in, nothing converts	Resource. A role with targets
Canning	Not started. Opens bottle shops and bars	Decide. See the box below

The Tap Room is not being closed. It is being asked to earn its keep a different way.

THE CLIMB TO 1,000

206

SYSTEMS IN THE DATABASE NOW

~9×

MULTIPLE NEEDED TO HIT 1,000

116

OWNERS WHO BOUGHT ELSEWHERE

The cheapest growth is the 116 who already own a system and already refill here. Their objections are overcome. Nobody has to be sold on the idea of beer at home.

Partners move this number, campaigns do not. Harvey Norman, Kegland and Benchy each put Tap That in front of people who have already bought the hardware.

A nine-times climb is not a marketing target, it is a distribution target. It needs partners, not posts.

UNIT ECONOMICS, AND THE ARGUMENT

One wholesale account is worth about ten households. That ratio is the whole case for resourcing wholesale ahead of another consumer campaign.

Members leak at 18%, non-members at 44%. Attaching membership to a system sale is the single highest-return retention move available.

The story is cost per schooner at home against a pub schooner at \$12 to \$18. Not sticker price on a keg.

63% of customers said they would host a demo at their own place. That is a distribution channel sitting unused, and it costs nothing but coordination.

Two membership programmes are running against one business. If the room becomes a destination and refills lead, one of them is paying for a shape the business no longer has. Redesign both around the refill, or drop one.

The at-home per-schooner figure is not settled. Three different sets of maths are in circulation and one is on a live ad. Settle it before it goes in any collateral.

THE CANNING QUESTION

Christy raised it. Tap That pushed back. No decision was taken.

For: a bottle shop is where people who drink beer find out the brand exists at all, which no amount of keg marketing reaches. It also opens bars and restaurants that will not give up a tap, and shipping cans goes further than shipping kegs.

Against: low margin, high effort, and it competes directly with the refill model this plan is built on. Tap That has already priced a small line at eight cans a minute and parked it, on the grounds that it adds a thing to a business that is not yet nailing the things it has.

What would settle it: a costed run through the cannery contact next door, priced against Earth Brew at about \$36 a four-pack. Premium small batch, not a price fight.

Worth revisiting if walk-in trade is wound back and a new awareness channel is needed.

DECISIONS REQUIRED

- **Pause walk-in trading?** Owner: Justin. The rest of the plan assumes yes.
- **Fund a wholesale role?** Full-timer or commissioned agent, with KPIs either way.
- **Attach membership to every system sale?** Retention maths says yes.
- **Commission the canning feasibility?** A number, not an opinion.
- **Settle the per-schooner figure.** Then pull or correct the live ad.

WHAT COULD GO WRONG

- **Pausing walk-ins costs community.** The room built the ambassadors. Replace it with systems before it goes, not after.
- **Wholesale hire without a process.** A salesperson with no CRM behind them will fail the same way the founders did.
- **Cutting the range too fast.** The tail costs money, but some of it is why people come.
- **Everything at once.** The recurring failure has been starting things and moving on. Three moves finished beats ten started.

Justin’s own point in the catch-up: as this scales, the personal connection cannot hold. It has to be replicated in systems.



THE POSITION

The pub at your place. Fresher, cheaper by the schooner, and yours.

Tap That is not a brewery that also delivers. It is the way a household stops paying pub prices. That framing changes who the competitor is, what the range should be, and who the marketing is talking to.

It also settles what Tap That is not. Not a craft brewery competing on taps, not a bottle shop competing on price, and not a venue competing for a Friday night.

Look for what the category does badly, not what it does well. Christy’s example was a New York restaurant that benchmarked where everyone else was weakest, found it was beer, and made beer the thing it celebrated. The pub does beer at home badly. That is the same gap.

Nobody on the Gold Coast owns this category, in market or in search. That is the opening.

WHO THE ENEMY IS

Overpriced pubs. Not the duopoly, not A&A, not the keg delivery operators.

Every price conversation should be unit economics against a \$12 to \$18 pub schooner. Being dearer than another keg supplier is defensible. Losing a sticker fight is not, and A&A cannot be beaten on sticker without giving away the margin this business runs on.

Do not get pulled into a keg price war. It is the one fight where winning costs more than losing.

A&A’s domain is suspended and they have merged with Burleigh Homebrew. The competitor that set the price anchor is not in good health, which makes following them down worse than pointless.

The at-home per-schooner figure still needs settling. Use the comparison, not a number, until it is.

HEROES, NOT A TAIL

About 19 brew choices is costing twice: cost of goods on the tail, and choice paralysis at the point of sale. It also means no single beer gets enough marketing to become known.

Cutting the tail is not the point. The point is putting the freed marketing energy behind the heroes that remain. Romance the beer, not the venue.

Add social proof at the point of sale: most popular, award winning, what to eat with it. Missing in the room and missing on the site.

27 taps and roughly a third not beer is core identity, not clutter. Cut brews, not the breadth of drink types.

DESIGN FOR HER

The single largest unaddressed opportunity in the brand.

The range, the marketing and the hardware all read masculine. Covered is not the same as catered for. Christy’s argument is the blunt one: if women are not coming, men will not follow.

What it means in practice: romance the RTD properly, build the hydration and light range as a real story, make products she is proud to serve, and design a system she is willing to have in eyesight at home.

Where to start: wellness influencer collaborations, and co-developing something with a local fitness brand. Christy’s example was a protein beer. The point is a product she would choose, not a product she tolerates.

This is a product and design brief, not a campaign. It will not be solved by a post.

PROOF ALREADY OWNED AND BARELY USED

- Crafted Brewers’ Choice award. Won, and almost invisible. It belongs on the site, in the room, on the tap decals and in social.
- Fits any system. A buying objection answered, currently below the fold.
- No CO2 with Talos kegs. Gas bottle management is a real barrier for new owners and this removes it.
- 1,000 giveaway entries. Demand for the hardware is demonstrated, not assumed.
- Strong reviews. Present, unpromoted, and invisible to AI search.

IDENTITY HOUSEKEEPING, AND WHAT IS STILL OPEN

- The name on the mark. Documents say Tap That Brewery, the badge says Brewery & Keghouse. Founders’ call. Until it is made, never crop the badge.
- Two live membership posters quote different prices. One has to be withdrawn.
- Source files. Vector logos and font names are still outstanding, so the colour and type calls in the guidelines stay provisional.
- Category language. Commercial brewer invites mainstream price comparison. The category needs a name of its own.

VOICE, AND THE RULE THAT GOVERNS IT

Green leads, gold accents, never the reverse. Bold condensed caps for headlines, a plain workhorse sans for reading. No scripts, no serifs.

Two registers. Cheeky for names and moments, at exactly the level the trading name sets. Plain and generous for money, service and responsibility. Never crude beyond the name’s own wink, never beer-snob, never discount-shouty.

Photography: the real room, real customers, available light. Not stock, and not anything that could not have been taken at Burleigh Heads.

The event flyers already built follow this. They are the reference for anything new.



BEFORE ANYTHING ELSE: CONNECT THE SYSTEM

Nothing talks to anything. Every campaign is set up to underperform before it launches.

META ADS

Working. Driving traffic and foot traffic already.
Needs: somewhere to send the traffic.

WEBSITE

A brochure, not a conversion tool. No path to a system or a refill.
Needs: a buy path, proof, and an FAQ.

POS

Sales happen here and never reach the customer record.
Needs: to write back to the CRM.

CRM

Partly built, stalled. Blanket 90-day SMS is the only automation.
Needs: consumption triggers and segments.

ONLINE STORE

Partly built, stalled. Cannot support the offers this plan needs.
Needs: memberships, vouchers, delivery.

This is the first unlock. Spending more on ads before it is fixed buys traffic the business cannot catch.

WHO WE ARE TALKING TO, AND WHAT CHANGES

SEGMENT	THE MESSAGE
Owns a system, bought elsewhere 56% of refill customers	You already have the hardware. We are the beer. First keg on us
Lapsed, forgot	Consumption-triggered reminder, free delivery, one tap to reorder
Lapsed, cutting back	Low, non-alcoholic, low-carb. A healthier option, not less beer
Never owned a system	Cost per schooner against the pub. No CO2. Try it at a party first
Tour and event operators	Award-winning stop, parking for a bus, a tasting they can sell
Venues and clubs	Margin, exclusivity, club-branded kegs, season guarantees

THE TWO HIGHEST-RETURN MOVES

01 · Convert the owners who are already sold.

Gift with purchase or a first-keg-free voucher tied to Harvey Norman system sales. Buy the Kegland and corny keg owner databases. Pursue the Benchy partnership. The model is the one kitchen installers use with Bunnings: they sell the hardware, we are the named first call for what goes in it.

02 · Take the friction out of reordering.

Free delivery works and the margin comes back in dollars, not percent. Replace the blanket 90-day SMS with consumption-triggered reminders, because about 60% reorder within three months and 40% take longer, and one clock fails both. Lead on no CO2. Rethink party rental so a minimum keg guarantee covers the hire fee instead of a \$75 barrier.

03 · Split the lapsed list in two.

Two cohorts, and one message is currently going to both. Some are cutting back, which needs the low and non-alcoholic range. Some simply did not get around to it, which is friction and needs one tap to reorder. **The split between them is not established.** The deck puts 40% on cutting back; in the room Christy put 40% on the lapse rate itself and said what they report is not getting around to it. Read it off the CRM before either message is written.

Jewell Projects holds Harvey Norman contacts at franchisee level, plus a contact who has done 20,000-plus installs for Harvey Norman, JB Hi-Fi and The Good Guys.

WHOLESALE AS A FUNCTION

Bars have approached Tap That and it still has not converted. That is not a demand problem, it is the absence of follow-up and sales experience.

Stand it up properly: a full-timer or a commissioned agent, targets and KPIs, a pipeline in the CRM rather than in someone's head. The room put it at about twelve touch points before a venue buys beer, and Tap That has the first one and almost none of the eleven after it.

Then go after the shape of it: custom systems for sporting clubs, club-branded kegs, minimum guarantees per season, and moving rigs from footy to cricket so they earn year-round.

And work around the duopoly. Lock-in is not satisfaction. Venues are already forming buying groups to get around it. Find the pain points and build an offer that fits alongside the contract.

One account is worth about ten households. This is where the leverage is.

FOUND BY PEOPLE, AND BY MACHINES

Within six to twelve months a large share of web traffic will expect an answer from AI search rather than a list of links. The site has to be readable by both.

The basics that are missing: a real About page, an FAQ that answers the buying objections, reviews on the site rather than off it, and the awards page the Crafted win deserves.

Reviews are the cheapest asset here. They exist, they are strong, and they sit on platforms rather than on the site where a model can read them.

Then the category play: nobody owns beer at home on the Gold Coast in search. Owning it is cheaper now than it will ever be again.

WHAT WE MEASURE

Systems
IN MARKET, AGAINST 1,000

Active
REFILL CUSTOMERS, ONE DEFINITION

Leak
LAPSE RATE, MEMBER VS NON-MEMBER

Accounts
WHOLESALE, AND KEGS PER ACCOUNT

One report, monthly, four numbers. Not a dashboard nobody opens.

Active customer is currently defined three ways. Pick one before the first report, or the number will be argued about instead of acted on.

NINETY DAYS : proposed, and dated off the 15 September catch-up

NOW · TO FRI 18 SEPT

■ Justin returns the committed moves

■ Clent and Christy regroup after Thu 17th

■ Settle the per-schooner figure, pull or fix the live ad

■ Pick one definition of an active customer

SPRINT 1 · 22 SEPT TO 17 OCT

■ Connect website, POS and CRM

■ Consumption-triggered reminders replace the 90-day SMS

■ Destination offer live: tours, weddings, functions

■ Harvey Norman and Kegland conversations opened

SPRINT 2 · 20 OCT TO 14 NOV

■ Wholesale role starts, with targets

■ Membership attached to every system sale

■ Award and proof assets across site and venue

■ Lapsed split into forgot and cutting back

SPRINT 3 · 17 NOV TO 12 DEC

■ Range cut to heroes, with the marketing behind them

■ Wellness and light range briefed

■ Designing for her, as a product brief

■ Canning decision taken on costed numbers

Clent is overseas from the end of September. Sprint 1 ownership needs to survive that.

THE DESTINATION PROGRAMME

The room already makes money on events. This is about selling them deliberately.

Tours. Get onto the circuit. The bus parking is an asset, not a liability. Build the Urban Legends booking widget so operators stop coordinating venue by venue.

Weddings and functions. PR to tourism operators, event and wedding planners. The signature wedding brew turns one booking into reception volume and a take-home sample for every guest.

Ticketed events and collabs. Own the calendar rather than waiting for walk-ins.

Party rental is the quiet one. A system in a house for a weekend is a demo that the host runs for you, in front of exactly the people who might buy one.

Romance the Crafted Brewers’ Choice award everywhere in this. It is the reason a tour operator picks this stop.

PARTNERSHIPS TO OPEN

WHO	THE PLAY	LEAD
Harvey Norman	GWP or first keg free at point of sale, plus the buyer database	Clent
Kegland / corny keg	Buy the owner databases	Tap That
Benchy	Official partnership and database	Tap That
Mark’s venues	About 300 weddings a year across two venues	Clent
Zip water contacts	About 1,000 distribution points	Clent
Cannery contact	Clent’s neighbour, former head of the country’s largest cannery. Costed feasibility	Clent

Named in the catch-up. None has been approached yet.

ARTWORK, ALREADY BUILT

Four A4 event flyers are print-ready in Tap That’s own format: weddings, bucks and hens, work functions, tours and tastings. Copy is a first pass and expects an edit.

Two image sets exist. One on commissioned concept photography, one on August site-visit photography. The concept set looks better and is right for a pitch. Anything going out as real venue marketing runs the venue set, or the four frames get shot properly.

What is still needed: a wording pass from Christy, the per-schooner figure settled before any price goes on a flyer, and a decision on whether these print or stay digital.

Tap That’s guidelines rule out anything that could not have been taken at Burleigh Heads. That is the test.

WHO DOES WHAT : R responsible · A accountable · C consulted

WORKSTREAM	JUSTIN	CHRISSY	HARRY	CLENT	CHRISTY	JP
The shape decision	A	A	C	C	C	–
Connected data, CRM, site	A	C	C	C	–	R
Wholesale build	A	C	C	C	C	C
Destination programme	A	C	R	C	C	R
Partnerships	C	–	–	R	–	C
Brand, range, proof	A	R	R	–	R	C
Campaign artwork	A	–	C	–	C	R

Draft for the next conversation. Wholesale has no R on purpose: that is the hire. Harry carries activation, as agreed in the catch-up.

CHECKPOINTS

■ Thu 17 Sept.

Justin’s commitments back.

■ w/c 21 Sept.

Clent and Christy regroup, plan confirmed, owners named.

■ Fri 17 Oct.

Sprint 1 review. Is the data connected and are reminders live?

■ Fri 14 Nov.

Sprint 2 review. Wholesale pipeline and membership attach rate.

■ Fri 12 Dec.

Ninety-day review against the 1,000 systems north star.

Every review asks one question first: did the number of systems in market move?